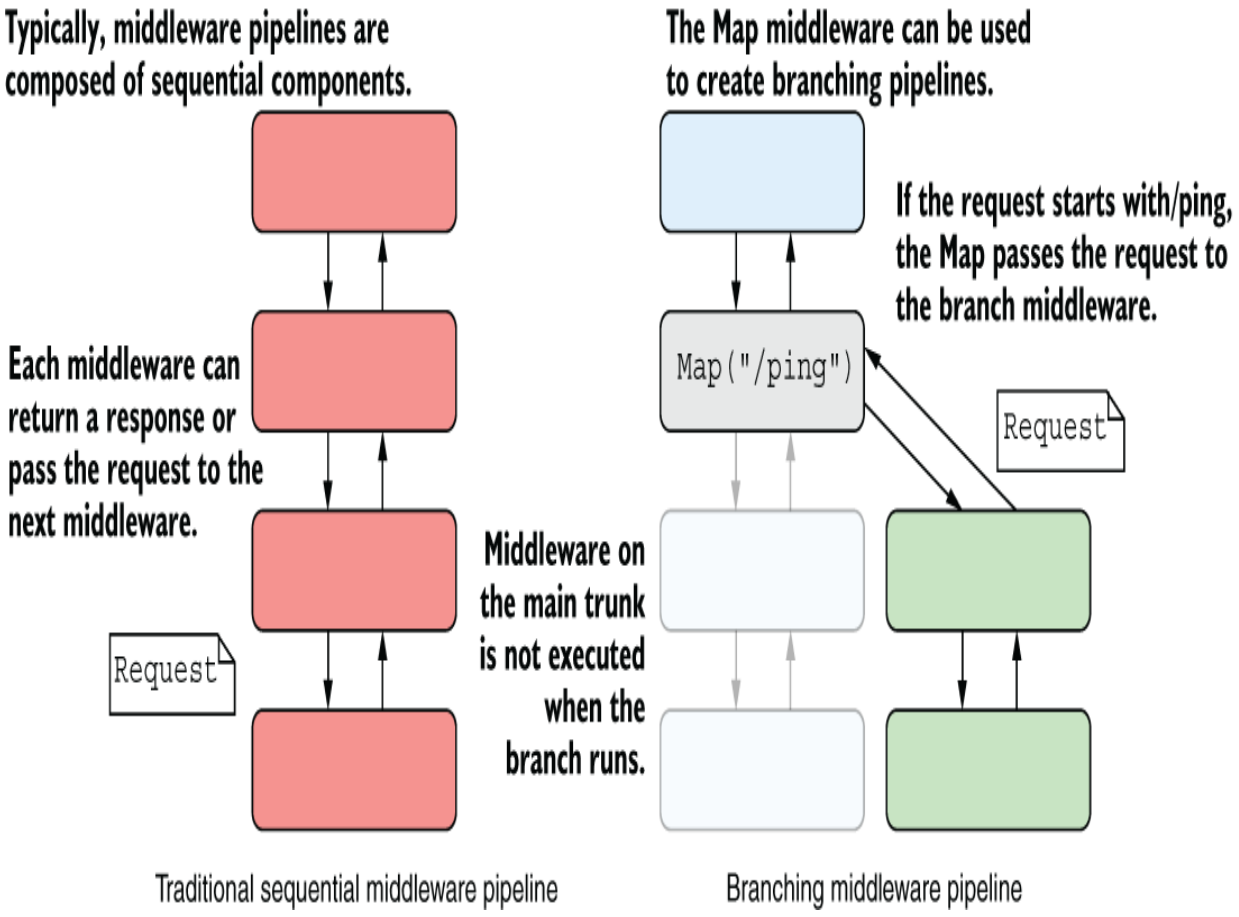


Figure 31.1 A sequential middleware pipeline compared with a branching pipeline created with the `Map` extension. In branching middleware, requests pass through only one of the branches at most. Middleware on the other branch never see the request and aren't executed.

NOTE The URL-matching used by `Map` is conceptually similar to the routing you've seen throughout the book, but it is much more basic, with many limitations. For example, it uses a simple string-prefix match, and you can't use route parameters. Generally, you should favor using endpoint routing instead of branching using `Map`. A similar extension, `MapWhen`, allows matching based on anything in `HttpContext`, such as headers or query string parameters.